

DAL by 1.3

54%



ATL win 46% · pick'em (0) · DAL win 54%

Shaded area each side of pick'em = each team's win chance; dark tick = our call.

Projected score DAL 83 — ATL 84 · Total 185

Some inputs served from the most-recent available build (winprob) — see companion file for detail.

Read

DAL is the narrow side of a near coin-flip (54% to win). The catch: ATL is down a rotation piece — I. Nivar (impact +0.7) is OUT and already removed from the projection below.

- DAL is the narrow side of a near coin-flip here (54% to win); we project DAL 83, ATL 84.
- The model's on-court player ratings tilt to ATL — its top three rate +6.5 combined vs +3.5 on the other side (impact = points added vs an average player; see the box).
- Availability: ATL without T. Paopao, I. Nivar (2 OUT) — OUT players are excluded from the box; the minutes of any projected among them are redistributed into the rotation below.
- How sure: 4 games in 5 the DAL margin lands between -16 and +17 (+ = DAL ahead) — single games swing a lot, and even so DAL loses outright about 46% of the time.

Injuries & availability — out of the projected box

TEAM	PLAYER	STATUS / CAUSE	GAMES MISSED	EXP. RETURN
ATL	Te-Hina Paopao	Leg	2	Aug 10
ATL	Indya Nivar	Coach's decision	3	Jul 29

Cause read from the injury feed's report; games missed = the team's games played since the player last appeared; expected return as reported ('TBD' = no date given).

Players to watch

Each side's top two projected scorers — biggest game-changer first (impact = points added vs an average player); the % is the team's scoring each carries.

- ATL A. Gray 17 pts (20% of ATL's scoring) / 3 reb / 2 ast in 31 min · +1.3 impact · R. Howard 14 pts (17% of ATL's scoring) / 4 reb / 3 ast in 32 min · -0.5 impact
- DAL P. Bueckers 19 pts (23% of DAL's scoring) / 4 reb / 6 ast in 33 min · +1.2 impact · J. Shepard 13 pts (16% of DAL's scoring) / 12 reb / 5 ast in 33 min · +0.2 impact

Projected box

Big # = jersey · bold above the line = projected starters (top-5 minutes) · IMPACT = points added vs an average player per 100 possessions (— = not yet rated).
Source: per-slate minutes + player-rate projections, availability-adjusted (minutes → 200, points scaled to the simulation score).

ATL

#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
3	J. Canada	+3.4	32.5	11.7	3.5	7.2	1.0
10	R. Howard	-0.5	32.3	13.9	3.6	3.3	2.6
15	A. Gray	+1.3	31.3	16.7	2.9	2.5	1.6

#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
00	N. Hillmon	+1.8	28.8	7.2	4.2	1.2	1.1
5	A. Reese	-0.2	27.3	13.9	9.3	1.8	0.3
42	B. Jones F · 6'3" · thin sample	+0.8†	14.3	6.5	4.9	1.6	0.4
20	I. Borlase	-0.1	13.6	5.1	1.5	1.1	0.7
11	M. Okot	-1.4	9.9	5.8	3.0	0.4	0.2
23	S. Kone	+1.2	6.6	2.6	1.2	0.4	0.3
33	S. Walker-Kimbrough G · 5'9" · thin sample	+1.0	2.0	0.4	0.2	0.2	0.1
32	A. Nye G · 6'0" · thin sample	-0.1	1.4	0.4	0.1	0.2	0.1
	Team		200.0	84.2			

DAL

#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
32	J. Shepard	+0.2	33.1	13.0	11.5	4.8	0.2
5	P. Bueckers	+1.2	32.6	19.2	4.2	5.5	1.5
35	A. Fudd	+1.2	31.2	11.8	2.1	2.4	1.9
24	A. Ogunbowale	-1.0	28.9	12.6	2.8	2.7	1.6
20	M. Siegrist	+0.5	13.9	5.3	2.3	0.8	0.7
34	A. Kuier	+0.1	12.4	3.9	2.6	0.7	0.4
28	L. Yueru	+0.3	9.5	3.3	3.0	0.5	0.4
8	A. Smith	+1.0	9.3	3.1	2.0	0.4	0.4
1	O. Sims	-0.6	8.7	3.3	0.7	1.3	0.4
7	A. Clark	-1.9	7.9	1.7	1.0	0.6	0.3
10	A. James	+0.2	6.9	3.2	1.2	0.8	0.3
6	C. Verona G · 5'7" · thin sample	-0.0	5.6	2.2	0.8	0.7	0.2
	Team		200.0	82.6			

A deeper look

What tonight means

A win tonight puts **ATL**'s playoff chances at **99%** — a loss drops them to **99%**.

Across both teams that makes this the **8th-biggest playoff-swing game** of this week's 14 remaining games.

ATL	if they win		99%
	if they lose		99%
	Playoff swing: 1 points · Typical seed: about 5th either way.		
DAL	if they win		100%
	if they lose		100%
	Playoff swing: 0 points · Typical seed: about 3rd with a win, 4th with a loss.		

Source: the rest of the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result (may differ from the headline odds by a fraction of a point — same simulation, different run counts).

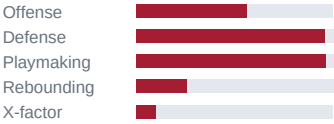
Season odds — playoffs & title

ATL	PLAYOFFS	TITLE	
	99%	22.8%	
DAL	PLAYOFFS	TITLE	
	100%	6.8%	

Source: live 1M-run season simulation (the board's odds core).

Starting-five skill profiles

3 J. Canada



10 R. Howard



15 A. Gray



00 N. Hillmon



5 A. Reese



32 J. Shepard



5 P. Bueckers



35 A. Fudd

No prior-season skill data yet (first WNBA season)

24 A. Ogunbowale



20 M. Siegrist



Source: league-percentile bars from each player's most recent full-season profile (the 2025 season); first-year players have none yet. Estimated from public play-by-play.

Appendix — how the numbers are made

- Scores, totals & the margin distribution = a 1M-run Monte-Carlo simulation; spread = regression + home recalibration; the margin curve & ranges are calibrated intervals (~89% observed coverage at the 90% target); playoff leverage = the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result.
- Player values = per-minute rates (last-10-games form → season → positional average) × projected minutes, team points scaled to the simulation total. Minutes = per-slate projection + injury redistribution under per-player caps — OUT players removed and their minutes reallocated (box sums to 200; a "provisional" team has rotation players missing from tonight's model, so its box shows only the modeled minutes and is not inflated).
- Some player-level estimates lean on the limited public play-by-play for this league; richer tracking data would sharpen them.

THE SEASON SO FAR (through 998 games): Our spread calls miss by an average of 10.8 points · when we make a team a 60%+ favorite, they win 68% of the time · player minutes within +/-6.0, points within +/-3.9 (player lines: reconstructed day-before for all 143 games; live tracking began Jul 8.)
Recent monthly accuracy (average miss, lower is better): May '25 9.9 · Jun '25 10.7 · Jul '25 11.7 · Aug '25 10.0 · Sep '25 10.3 · May '26 11.1 · Jun '26 10.6 · Jul '26 12.2 points.
all-games: spread +/-10.8 · minutes +/-6.0 · points +/-3.8

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